11:12). In the meantime, Christians were to understand that Jews were in fact "supporting" them, just as "roots are supporting a tree" (Rom. 11:18).

However, when it came to practical matters, when they had to deal with the populace, the Churches usually found it more expedient to resort to binary oppositions: Christianity was therefore always pure, holy, and beautiful; Judaism was perverted, sinful, and ugly. It was so much easier for the churches to cast Jews as enemies or pariahs than to grant them anything like an "elder brother" status. A crypto-Marcionism, as we would prefer to call it, thus crept into Christian culture ever since the Middle Ages, and spread eventually to post-Christian Western culture as well, as secular socio-political antisemitismemerged, according to which Jews were the main obstacle to the Good Society and had either to be removed or annihilated.

The success of Mel Gibson's 2004 movie, *The Passion of the Christ*, has testified to the residual strength of Marcionism among Christian believers even today. This is so despite major efforts of the churches, especially since the Holocaust, to go back to the Pauline model. Regarding political Marcionism, an earlier example comes to mind—that of Charles de Gaulle, leader of the Free French during World War Two, an enemy of Nazi Germany and resolute opponent of Marshal Pétain's Vichy regime (including its antisemitic legislation). Indeed, the first thing he did when the Free French took over a Vichy-ruled territory was to abrogate Vichy's infamous Jew's Statute, restoring full rights to Jews as French citizens and human beings. Yet the same de Gaulle, as founder and first president of the Fifth Republic, delivered an utterly antisemitic diatribe in a press conference on November 27, 1967. He not only defamed the State of Israel as an aggressor in the Six-Day War, but also as an illegitimate entity created in "dubious circumstances." He went so far as to describe the Jewish people at large as an "elite, self-confident and domineering people" with large resources in "money, influence and propaganda" in "many countries," especially "America." The former leader of the anti-Nazi Resistance now sounded as if he were echoing the *Protocols of Elders of Zion* or worse, the paramount 19th-century French antisemite, Edouard Drumont. I remember how I felt as a young French Jew when I heard de Gaulle on the radio: it was as if the blood in my veins ran cold.[6]

In retrospect, what happened to de Gaulle looks rather obvious. We know that he was raised in a Catholic-social milieu, where both left- and right-wing antisemitism was rampant—even if his father is said to have sided with Captain Dreyfus. We know that in the 1930s he rebelled against the French military and political Establishment, well before his opposition to Marshal Pétain in 1940. In those years, the only military expert who took him

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